My Personal Development Plan

Name:	**Muhammad Imran**
Course:	**MSc. Data Science for Business**
Date:	**12/10/2025**
Updated:	**15/10/2025**

Part One- SWOT Analysis

STRENGTHS Think about: What experience and knowledge do I have? What do I do well? What are my skills and capabilities? What do I know about the subject? What do others think? What is my attitude to this?	WEAKNESSES Think about: What are the potential barriers? What could I improve? What should I avoid? What resources do I lack? What do others think?
I consider teamwork to be one of my key strengths. I enjoy working collaboratively and contributing towards shared goals, and I have consistently been a reliable and supportive team member. I find that working with others not only helps achieve better results but also creates a positive and motivating environment. I am particularly strong at breaking down complex problems into simple, manageable steps, which has helped me throughout my academic journey, especially in data science and statistical analysis. This approach allows me to stay organised and find practical solutions efficiently. I also have a solid foundation in mathematics and data analysis, which supports my ability to think logically and work with data confidently. I am adaptable and open to new experiences, which has helped me grow both personally and professionally while studying in Scotland. I enjoy meeting new people, understanding different perspectives, and continuously learning from my surroundings. In addition, I take pride in my communication and writing skills. I am able to express ideas clearly, whether in academic work or informal settings, and I enjoy writing and sharing insights. I am also someone who likes to plan ahead, stay organised, and approach tasks with a structured mindset, which helps me stay productive and focused.	One area I am working on is my confidence in public speaking, especially when presenting to larger groups. I am comfortable in smaller discussions, but I am gradually building confidence by taking part in presentations and pushing myself to speak more openly. I have also noticed that I can improve my financial planning, as I sometimes spend more than intended during travel or social activities. To manage this better, I am starting to track my expenses and follow a more structured budget.
OPPORTUNITIES Think about: What interests me in this? What might be possible? What would I like to do if nothing holds me back? What is available? What can I learn? What can I develop?	**THREATS** Think about: What happens if I struggle? What if I lose interest? What are the limitations? What is holding me back? What might prevent me meeting goals?
I see strong opportunities in building a career in data science and artificial intelligence, particularly in roles such as data scientist, AI engineer, or data analyst within the healthcare or public sector. These areas align closely with my interests in using data to solve real-world problems and improve decision-making. I am especially interested in developing skills in machine learning and predictive modelling, which can be used for tasks such as demand forecasting and identifying patterns in data. I am also keen to explore how AI technologies, such as chatbots and generative AI, can be applied to improve efficiency and user experience in organisations. To support this, I am actively learning Python and working with business intelligence tools to strengthen my analytical and technical capabilities. By combining data science, AI, and business analytics skills, I aim to build a strong professional profile and open up opportunities in data-driven roles, particularly in sectors like healthcare where data can have a meaningful impact.	One potential challenge is balancing my academic workload with the time required to further develop advanced skills in AI and data science. However, I see this as an opportunity to improve my time management and prioritisation skills. I am committed to dedicating consistent effort towards learning and self-development alongside my studies. With the right planning and discipline, I am confident in my ability to achieve my goals and continue progressing professionally. This approach will not only support my long-term career growth but also strengthen my ability to adapt and succeed in a competitive environment.

Part Two- Skills Audit

Skill/Ability definition	Current skills level (1, 2, 3)	Your current evidence of this skill (evidence /examples both positive and negative)
Interpersonal Skills		
1. Comfortable in social situations 2. Appreciates the views of others 3. Adjusts behaviour to account for other people 4. Maintains good communication within groups of people	2 3 3 3	I contribute meaningfully and enjoy social gatherings, that I enjoyed during my time at the High School and University. Joining the sports team and working with clubs and societies shows I am comfortable in social situations and sometimes enjoy a lot. Listen everyone because I believe others view can pay you smart and make you learn more. I learned this kind of appreciation during my university life… where you are listened and your views are valued, something helpful for everyone's grooming. Absolutely I am adaptable and enjoy accounting for other people and spending quality time with them. I am an active member of Striling Sports Union and have met with people of different values and beliefs and account for their views to adjust in a well-connected society. Yes, and I think good communication within your group is a key to success. It helps you share your ideas as groups are excellent to learn, grow and collaborate with each other.
Management Skills		
1. Organises self to complete set tasks 2. Sets and achieves objectives 3. Plans best use of resources for self and others	3 3 3	I am quite Judging and plans everything beforehand, it helped me grow both personally and professionally. Organizing tasks also helps me achieve goals, do assignments timely and plan days for effective learning. I like to set objectives and work hard for achieving them, that I learned in my days at the University of Stirling. Learning in an organised way not only help getting the goals but also plan things accordingly. I have good access to resources in my university i.e., library material, study spaces, online learning and canvas slides that gave me confidence to use them effectively and gain maximum advantages in getting high grades during my studies and support others' too.

Learning Skills		
1. Willing to learn 2. Keen to learn and has a plan 3. Tries to improve learning ability 4. Strategic about learning for self and others	3 3 2 3	I always like to learn new skills, problem solving techniques and data analytics concepts best to help me land my first data science job. Having a clear plan of learning and dedicating your efforts really helps you learn it quickly. So, I love to have plans and go step by step like learning python I will first learn data types, then functions and lastly will move to libraries. Looking to improve your learning experience is a part of learning so I always look for ways to improve my productivity, communication and creative skills. I am quite good at learning other strengths and tries to inculcate those skills in myself so I might be able to reflect for self and others' abilities and what areas are there to improve.
Written Communication		
1. Uses accurate language 2. Writes with the reader in mind 3. Can write for a variety of purposes	3 2 3	Language is a key for sharing feelings, delivering ideas and writing effectively. So, yes, I feel comfortable using appropriate language when doing assignments, writing emails and working on academic projects. Writing according to the readers' mind helps catch attention, that aligns with my values. Yes, I have ability to write both academic and social aspects of life. I like to read blog posts on medium and have written some as well.
Verbal Communication		
1. Can hold a conversation 2. Is skilled in conversation and discussion 3. Can help others communicate	3 2 3	I believe holding an effective communication and collaborate effectively with group members is very important when holding conversations, and I am quite well with it. I am skilled in conversation and discuss ideas seamlessly but sometimes also prefer me time. I help others communicate and like to listen to them effectively and giving confidence to speak.
Problem-Solving		
1. Can identify a problem 2. Can identify solutions 3. Can analyse relevant information and investigate options 4. Can apply creative thinking in search of a solution	3 3 2 3	My skills in identifying the problem are excellent that guided me to purse master's in data science. I also have good problem-solving skills; my assignments and projects argue the statement and am motivated to identify and implement future business solutions in my profession. I worked on my dissertation project where I had to get relevant information and investigate options to identify the solutions and pick the right one. So, yes, I am quite good at it.

		I am working on delivering a sustainable project of the year in collaboration with Uniforce to support green transitions in Scotland that shows my creativity and excellent approach in delivering solutions.
Information & Communication Technology		
1. Has basic computer skills 2. Can use a range of software 3. Can manage ICT facilities	3 3 3	I have an outstanding computer skills and digital literacy that I learned during my high school and university time and is a must-have skill in the current era of AI. Of course, my proficiency with multiple software like Anaconda, Microsoft 365, R Studio, MATLAB, GitHub and Azure along with range of others make me stand out as a good data scientist. I am comfortable working with both hardware and software communication systems and my courses like IoT, Machine Learning, Software Engineering and Business Analytics represent that.
Numbers and Data		
1. Can do basic arithmetic operations 2. Can interpret graphs and tables 3. Can estimate, calculate and manipulate data 4. Can design numerical investigations	3 3 3 3	I am good at maths and can perform basic algorithmic operations very well, and I learned these skills during my whole academic years. I have excellent practice working with Tableau, Excel, and BI tools that demonstrate my good graphic interruption and dashboard skills. Yes, I like manipulating data, cleaning and performing calculations on it and do analytical work best for being a successful data scientist. Designing numerical investigation is something I have really being working on it since my childhood and grasps good knowledge of representing and designing numerical data.
Team Working		
1. Can work with others 2. Ability to be an effective member of a team 3. Ability to lead and motivate a team	3 3 3	Teamwork is my passion, and I enjoy working in groups. I learned this skill during my time at the University of Stirling and have passion to work with others well. I have been an excellent member of lots of teams during my time at schools, and college where I learned how you can perform at your best in team and achieve the goals. I am leading a team of four member working with Uniforce on real-world project that shows I have outstanding ability to lead and manage team and collaborate with each for setting up the goals.
Commercial Awareness		
1. Have an understanding of the business environment 2. Can speculate about the future 3. Understand the past to predict the future	2 3	I have a good understanding of the business world but need to learn more about market research, how to achieve set targets, understand competitors, and perform benchmarking. For sure and I have done some real projects to forecast future demand for bike usage in Stirling.

	3	I think understanding past to predict the future is the backbone of business analytics and I have good understanding of it that helped me get through my dissertation project.
Career Management Skills		
1. Has some concept of applying own skills to job applications 2. Understands self and how different jobs might suit 3. Takes a strategic approach to career planning 4. Is flexible, adaptable and proactive about careers	3 2 2 2	I know very well how I can apply my concepts to job applications and work for the success of the organization. I am aware of myself but still need to work on my career plannings and how different jobs might suit well to me. I take strategic approach to career planning but feels like I lag and must draw clear map of my skills and how these can be aligned with the current market demands. Being flexible and adaptable is a key to be successful in your professional career, I am good at it and like to be proactive about my careers, organising meetings with career teams will be best in that.

Part Three- Personal Short- term Smart Goals

Personal Goals				
OBJECTIVES What do I want to be able to do better? What do I want to achieve?	**ACTIONS** What will I do to achieve this?	**SUPPORT** What support and resources will I need?	**SUCCESS CRITERIA** How will I recognise/provide evidence of my success? How will I review and measure my improvement?	**TARGET DATES FOR REVIEW / COMPLETION**
Secure my first role as a Data Scientist / Data Analyst	Learn SQL, Python, and basic statistics; complete projects and build a portfolio.	Access to online platforms (e.g., Coursera), university career services, and consistent study time.	Secure a full-time role within the £30,000–£40,000 salary range, enabling me to apply my data science skills and grow professionally.	By the end of 2026
Develop strong financial stability and savings habits.	Create and follow a monthly budget; track expenses; begin saving and investing.	Financial tools (e.g., budgeting apps), guidance on savings (e.g., ISA accounts).	Save at least £20,000 and maintain consistent financial discipline.	By the end of 2027
Build a successful career and explore global opportunities.	Continue developing AI and data science skills; gain industry experience; pursue continuous learning.	Professional networks, online learning platforms, industry exposure.	Achieving career progression, financial independence, and ability to travel internationally.	Within the next ten years.

Part Four- My Personal Objectives

Personal Development Objectives
Short Term Goals
My short-term goal is to secure my first role as a Data Analyst or Data Scientist and begin applying my skills in a real-world, data-driven environment. This will allow me to gain practical experience, contribute to organisational objectives, and build a strong foundation in data analytics. At the same time, I aim to continue developing my technical skills in SQL, Python, and data visualisation tools.
Medium Term Goals
My medium-term goals focus on achieving financial stability and advancing my career in data science or business analytics. I aim to progress into more specialised roles by strengthening my knowledge in machine learning and artificial intelligence. Additionally, I plan to build consistent savings and develop financial discipline to support long-term personal and professional growth.
Long Term Goals
My long-term goal is to establish myself as a skilled data science or AI professional, contributing to innovative solutions that create real-world impact. I aim to achieve financial independence, continue learning advanced technologies, and explore global opportunities that support both personal fulfilment and professional success.

Part Five- My Picture of Success